

December 22, 2025

To Whom It May Concern,

The Terumo Life Science Foundation hereby confirms the awarding of a 2025 R&D Subsidy (Overseas) grant for the following research project:

Project title: “Early Detection of Alzheimer’s Disease and Mild Cognitive Impairment in Vietnamese Older Adults through Speech Analysis”

Project leader: Dr. Ha Thi Thanh Huong

International collaborator: MD., PhD. Taishiro Kishimoto (Keio University School of Medicine, Japan)

Project collaborators: MD. Hoang Tien Trong Nghia, Dr. Ngo Thanh Hoan

Student researcher: Vu Nguyen Minh Duc (International University—Vietnam National University Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam)

This letter confirms the following:

1. **Approved Research Funding:** The total approved grant amount is 2,000,000 JPY.
2. **Detailed Budget Allocation:** The budget was reviewed and approved as detailed in the budget table below.
3. **Student Researcher Involvement:** We confirm the participation of student researcher Vu Nguyen Minh Duc, including his involvement in a two-week training exchange to Japan to acquire advanced speech processing and analysis methodologies.

Official Development Assistance (ODA) Status: Importantly, the Terumo Life Science Foundation confirms that this funding does not constitute Official Development Assistance (ODA). It does not originate from governmental development-aid mechanisms, concessional finance, or bilateral/multilateral aid programs.

Budget Allocation

The total grant of 2,000,000 JPY will be allocated as follows:

Item	Unit	Price (JPY)	Description	Total (JPY)
A. Equipment				134,611

Zoom Handheld Recorder	H6	2	58,205	Professional 6-track digital audio recorder: 24-bit/96 kHz recording, interchangeable microphone capsules (X/Y, Mid-Side), 4 XLR/TRS inputs with phantom power, direct SD recording up to 128 GB, 20+ hour battery life.	116,410
Audio accessories (cables, memory cards)			5,598	Cables, high-speed SD cards (32GB Class 10)	5,598
Data storage with Google One for 12 months		1	12,603	Secure, backed-up server space for storing sensitive patient data	12,603
B. Research material and participant support					485,667
Cognitive assessment materials, printing, and documentation			11,197	This fee will cover the costs of informed consent documents and the assessment protocol. The materials include instruction cards and visual aids. Professional printing ensures standardized stimulus. The presentation is critical for ensuring reliable data collection from 160 participants.	11,197
Participant support		170	2,791	This fee compensates each participant with 1,675 JPY, and the remaining fee of 1,116 JPY covers the hospital's medical expenses for 160 participants and 10 pilot participants.	474,470
C. Clinical Assessment, medical consultation, and technician support					804,100
Clinical Assessment and Medical Supervision		170	3,910	Expert Clinical Services (3,910 JPY per participant): neurological assessment, DSM-5 criteria application, medical supervision, clinical interpretation, and	664,700

			participant safety monitoring for 160 participants and 10 pilot participants.	
Technician support	170	820	Each technical personnel member is paid 820 JPY per participant for data collection, equipment operation, participant scheduling, preliminary processing, and transcribing audio into text over six months.	139,400
D. Dissemination:				279,707
Conference presentations, publication fees, and patent fees		279,707	Publication fees include support for open-access publications (about 83,728 JPY) in neuroscience and medical journals to maximize research impact and establish international research in the dementia research community. The remainder (about 195,979 JPY) will be allocated for conference attendance.	279,707
E. Travel				295,915
Master's Student Training Exchange to Japan (2 weeks)	1	295,915	The funding will cover the travel fee to Japan, accommodation, and living expenses during the research exchange for training in advanced speech analysis methodology.	295,915
Total (JPY)				2,000,000

This confirmation letter is issued to support the administrative processing and implementation of the approved research project.

Sincerely,

2025. 12 . 26
Shigeki Ariura